

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Detection and Response Engineering, Microsoft Sentinel, Defender and Azure Security

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of enterprise experience in detection and response engineering, security capability design and implementation, and cyber risk reduction. I have strong hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Azure security, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), email security, and identity and access management including Entra ID/Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Privileged Access Management (PAM). In my current role at the University of the Arts London, I engineer and maintain security capabilities that enable early threat detection and rapid, consistent response across a complex enterprise environment of 8,000 users. I translate cyber risk and regulatory requirements into practical, measurable, and operationally sustainable security controls, and I have a strong understanding of security frameworks including NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, and CIS Controls. I bring curiosity, technical rigour, and a commitment to delivering security outcomes that genuinely reduce risk, and I am excited by the opportunity to contribute to Thames Water's cyber strategy and ongoing security capability programme.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM / Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; detection rule writing, alert tuning, coverage analysis
- **EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Microsoft Azure Security:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Conditional Access, Azure security architecture
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** MDE, Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID, Azure AD, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM (equivalent capability to CyberArk); privileged session monitoring and access governance
- **Email Security:** Mimecast gateway management; phishing investigation, policy configuration, impersonation protection
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle; Detection, Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery, Lessons Learned
- **Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK Framework gap analysis; hypothesis-driven hunting, hunt-to-detection pipeline
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management / Mobile Application Management)
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Engineer and maintain security capabilities enabling early threat detection, rapid response, and sustained cyber risk reduction across an 8,000-user enterprise environment

- Design, implement, and continuously improve detection and response engineering in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, writing KQL detection rules and tuning alert logic to improve fidelity
- Translate cyber risk, regulatory, and business demands into practical, measurable, and operationally sustainable security controls, aligned to NIST CSF, ISO 27001, and CIS Controls
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, ensuring comprehensive XDR coverage across endpoints and identities
- Manage identity and access controls through Entra ID/Azure AD including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and SSO configuration
- Administer Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, governing privileged account lifecycle and session monitoring
- Manage email security gateway (Mimecast), investigating phishing and Business Email Compromise (BEC) campaigns and maintaining gateway policy configurations
- Conduct vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), driving risk reduction and remediation tracking
- Lead incident response activities in line with NIST 800-61, including root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, eradication, and recovery
- Conduct threat hunting exercises aligned to MITRE ATT&CK framework, converting findings into detection rules and tuning recommendations
- Develop and automate SOAR response playbooks to orchestrate security operations and reduce manual analyst workload

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security alerts using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, escalating high-severity incidents to senior engineers with full investigation documentation
- Supported deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, substantially improving detection coverage and response capability
- Wrote and tuned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving SIEM signal quality and contributing to the detection engineering roadmap
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking remediation through to closure and reporting residual risk to stakeholders
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway policies and investigated phishing campaigns
- Supported Entra ID/Azure AD Conditional Access policy management and MFA enforcement
- Assisted in PAM administration (BeyondTrust), supporting privileged access reviews and onboarding processes
- Contributed to SOAR automation development and incident response playbook documentation

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security operations for a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, managing endpoint protection, infrastructure hardening, and access controls
- Administered network firewalls and maintained security gateway and perimeter configurations
- Assisted in vulnerability scanning, patch management, and remediation tracking processes
- Supported identity management, MFA configuration, and access control reviews

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users at UAL, delivering enterprise-wide XDR coverage and identity threat detection at scale
- Engineered KQL-based detection rules and tuning improvements in Microsoft Sentinel that materially reduced alert fatigue and improved detection fidelity across the SIEM estate
- Developed and automated SOAR response playbooks to orchestrate containment and triage actions, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-frequency incident types
- Led Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises to validate detection capabilities against real-world attack techniques, using results to prioritise the detection engineering roadmap

- Maintained UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification through continuous vulnerability management, control testing, and evidence production aligned to CIS Controls and NIST CSF

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Berkshire/UK)